

COINPICKS · RESEARCH & EDUCATION

Iran War Risk Pillar Report

Middle East Conflict Risk — Researched, Scored, and Personally Committed

*Originally written June 19, 2026; scores committed by me June 19, 2026. Fully re-researched July 8, 13, 18, 25, and 30, 2026, and again as a full weekly refresh on August 8, 2026 (P cut at 1mo/3mo, 24/31/41/56/77 → 20/28/41/56/77, committed and stamped by Alex). **This version (August 16) is a light daily touch and HOLDS FLAT at 20/28/41/56/77** (no cycle ran Aug 15). Three more ADNOC tanker incidents fired since the Aug 14 baseline (two Aug 14, one Aug 15) — no injuries, no direct Iranian claim of responsibility, comparable in kind to the Aug 8-13 pattern already priced in. This report's own "~Aug 16" 60-day Hormuz-window marker (dated from the June 15 MoU signing) passed today without a formal MoU withdrawal by either side; Bloomberg's Aug 15 coverage ("Iran, Oman Home In on Hormuz Strait Deal as Ship Attacks Mount") still frames the interim arrangement as advancing, not collapsed. **This version's scores have been auto-stamped** under Alex's standing delegated daily authority (in effect since 2026-08-06) — no pillar P moved anywhere in today's cycle; see My Decision below.*

COINPICKS PILLAR REPORT · WEIGHT: 25% OF MY THESIS

Written June 19, 2026 · Updated & Re-verified August 16, 2026 (light daily touch off the Aug 14 baseline — committed, auto-stamped) · Not Financial Advice

The Scores — Committed vs. Drafts

June column committed by me June 19, 2026 · every draft since shown for full lineage · Aug 8 (cut at 1mo/3mo, full weekly refresh) committed and stamped by Alex · Aug 9-16 are light daily touches — all held flat, all auto-stamped (no cycle ran Aug 15).

WINDOW	JUN	...	8/11	8/12	8/13	8/14	8/16	QUAL.	IMP.	SIGNAL	MY CALL
1 month	50	...	20	20	20	20	20	0.60	8	-2.88	Bear — the worst 1-month signal in the whole matrix
3 months	55	...	28	28	28	28	28	0.65	8	-2.29	Bear
6 months	62	...	41	41	41	41	41	0.70	8	-1.01	Mild Bear — held, evidence for this window didn't move
1 year	75	...	56	56	56	56	56	0.65	8	+0.62	Mild Bull (dip-buy thesis intact but still thin)
3 years	85	...	77	77	77	77	77	0.55	8	+2.38	Bull

Committed P (Aug 16): 20 / 28 / 41 / 56 / 77 · **Weight:** 20% (equal) · **Impact:** 8 (uniform) · **Formula:** Signal = ((P – 50) ÷ 50) × Quality × Impact. Full lineage: June committed 50/55/62/75/85 (Jun 19) → ... (see prior versions of this report for the full Jul 8–Aug 7 path) → Aug 8 20/28/41/56/77 (cut at 1mo/3mo — full-week re-verification surfaces five missed tanker attacks plus a new Saudi front — committed and stamped by Alex) → Aug 9-14 20/28/41/56/77 (held flat) → **Aug 16 20/28/41/56/77** (held flat — three more ADNOC tanker incidents, comparable in kind; ~Aug 16 60-day window passed without a formal MoU withdrawal) — committed, auto-stamped.

THE THREE INPUTS, IN PLAIN ENGLISH

P — the odds this is *good for crypto* by then. Held flat this cycle at 20/28/41/56/77. The UAE accused Iran/IRGC of striking two more ADNOC vessels Aug 14 (no injuries) and a further ADNOC vessel was hit in the hull Aug 15 (no injuries, UKMTO) — three tanker incidents in 48 hours, comparable in kind to the Aug 8-13 pattern (no casualties, no new state targeted, no direct Iranian claim of responsibility). This report's own "~Aug 16" 60-day Hormuz-window marker (dated from the June 15 MoU signing) passed today without a formal MoU withdrawal by either side; Bloomberg's Aug 15 coverage still frames the interim arrangement as advancing — Araghchi's "very close" framing, conditioned on US compliance with the June MoU, is unchanged. WTI ~\$81/bbl, well under the \$100 flip line. Held flat pending either a signed agreement or a development that clearly exceeds the Aug 14 baseline. 6mo/12mo/36mo held — the longer-horizon case (war exhaustion, allied diplomatic pressure) is unchanged.

Quality — how trustworthy the evidence is. Today's re-check rests on Al Jazeera, CBS News (citing UKMTO), and Bloomberg — well above the sufficiency bar, but the substance itself doesn't move the needle. Quality itself is unchanged this cycle per house rules.

Impact — 8 out of 10, the uniform value shared by every pillar in the equal-weight model. BTC closed at \$62,937.03 on Aug 16, +0.2% vs. Aug 14 — a modest tape move (see quant pillar), not an Iran-specific reaction.

The Claim

The thesis, and where I differ from the consensus — updated August 16, 2026, light daily touch

The crowd: keeps treating each "very close" or "agreement reached" announcement as if it were the resolution itself, rather than checking whether the underlying facts (an unsigned deal, continued attacks, hardening terms) actually moved.

Me: holding at 20/28/41/56/77 for a seventh straight touch (no cycle ran Aug 15). Three more ADNOC tanker incidents and a passed soft deadline are a continuation of an existing pattern, not a new substantive escalation; it doesn't clear the bar the way the Aug 8 Najran strike (a new front, 11 wounded) did. Moving the score on every additional tanker incident is exactly the mistake this pillar's own history (a week of "hold flat" daily touches that missed a real deterioration) already taught it to avoid — the discipline cuts both ways.

My edge: the crowd is vulnerable to treating "very close" as resolution and a single new attack report as fresh information, when neither exceeds what's already priced in. 6/12/36-month hold because the longer-horizon case — war exhaustion, allied diplomatic pressure via the Saudi-Turkey-Pakistan pact — is structurally unchanged.

The Facts

As of August 16, 2026, light daily touch — hard numbers only, sources on the last page. New facts appear first; the Aug 8-14 facts below are carried forward unchanged (still load-bearing).

- ★ ★ **NEW — three more ADNOC tanker incidents in 48 hours (Aug 14-15), comparable in kind to the established pattern.** The UAE accused Iran/IRGC of striking two ADNOC vessels Aug 14 (Al Jazeera, no injuries), and a further ADNOC vessel was hit in the hull Aug 15 (CBS News live desk citing UKMTO, no injuries — an "unknown projectile"). Iran did not claim direct responsibility either time; UAE's Foreign Ministry called it "piracy." No new state targeted, no casualties — continuation, not escalation.
- ★ ★ **NEW — the report's own "~Aug 16" 60-day Hormuz-window marker (dated from the June 15 MoU signing) passed today without a formal MoU withdrawal by either side.** Bloomberg's Aug 15 report ("Iran, Oman Home In on Hormuz Strait Deal as Ship Attacks Mount") still frames the interim arrangement as advancing — Araghchi's "very close" framing, conditioned on US compliance with the June MoU, is unchanged; no collapse or breakdown reported by any outlet checked.
- **WTI ~\$81/bbl** (VP Vance interview, Aug 14) — well under the \$100 flip line; gasoline averaging \$4.07/gal nationally vs. \$3.16 a year prior.
- **BTC closed at \$62,937.03 on Aug 16** — +0.2% vs. Aug 14's close of \$62,802.46 (no cycle ran Aug 15).

Carried forward from Aug 11-14 (still load-bearing):

- **Aug 13 — Hormuz deal remains unsigned, stuck on hardened compensation demands from both sides.** Reuters, US News, NBC, Washington Post, Al Jazeera, and The Hill (six independent outlets) reported Iran's stipulations explicitly include a US withdrawal of its naval blockade, compensation for war damages, asset unfreezing, and sanctions relief; Trump separately amended his own compensation demand to include damages "to the people of Lebanon, Syria, Yemen, and Gaza" — a hardening of the same dispute, not a new demand category.
- **Brent eased to ~\$87-90/bbl** (from the \$98-100+ spikes logged in late July) as Hormuz traffic stayed low as of Aug 13-14; a live tracker (straits.live) showed the Strait at "day 166" of closure — a lower-boil, still-disrupted status quo.
- **Aug 13 — Araghchi again called the Hormuz deal "very close" while conditioning full reopening on the US "making amends" over the June MoU** (CNN, NPR, Al Jazeera, France 24, Bloomberg, Fortune) — the same rephrased-condition picture now folded into today's compensation-dispute read.
- ★ **Aug 11 — a Houthi "double-tap" missile strike on the cargo vessel Tihamah in the Bab al-Mandeb Strait (Red Sea, not Hormuz) killed 6 (4 crew, 2 rescue workers)** per Yemeni government accounts, corroborated by US News/AP wire and Al Jazeera-linked reporting — a genuinely lethal incident, but in the same Houthi-proxy

Red Sea theater and comparable in kind to the Aug 8 ADNOC tanker hit and Aug 9 Jazan refinery strike already logged without moving P.

- **Iran's Supreme Leader reshuffled top military leadership (new armed-forces chief of staff, new IRGC commander)** — a structural development with an ambiguous, not-yet-legible directional read; flagged, not scored.
- **★ Houthi forces drone-struck Saudi Aramco's Jazan refinery on Aug 9**, a 400,000 bpd facility on Saudi Arabia's Red Sea coast. NBC News, Al Jazeera, CBC, NPR, UPI, and Al Bawaba (six independent outlets) report the strike; Saudi Arabia's energy ministry said there were no injuries and firefighters extinguished the resulting fire the same day, with no announced extended production impact.

Carried forward from Aug 8-10 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Iranian FM Araqchi says the Oman shipping-route deal is "very close" but conditions full reopening on new demands, including US compensation to Iran.** Reuters (via Investing.com, US News, Jakarta Post, Japan Times, Haaretz, Rappler, Aug 8-9): Araqchi said Iran and Oman are "very close" to an agreement on a new shipping route through the strait, but that reopening it would depend on further conditions, and that the previous shipping traffic separation scheme is "no longer acceptable to Tehran."
- ★ **The UAE says Iran struck another ship in the strait; Oman condemns "repeated attacks."** The same Reuters report: the UAE separately reported a fresh Iranian strike on a vessel transiting Hormuz, while Oman publicly condemned "repeated attacks on vessels" transiting the waterway without assigning blame, and described negotiations with Iran as "positive and constructive."

Carried forward from Aug 1-8 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Five separate Hormuz tanker/shipping incidents, Jul 31 - Aug 5, that daily two-day checks missed or undercounted.** The LNG carrier Gaslog Shanghai was struck and disabled carrying Qatari LNG (Jul 31); a separate explosion hit near a vessel on the Omani side (Aug 2); bulk carrier Minoan Pioneer was struck in the engine room, suffering a blackout with one crew member missing (Aug 3); two more explosions were reported near Kumzar (Aug 5). The IMO's cumulative incident tally now stands at 65 since the war began (Bloomberg/UANI), with Hormuz traffic described as "at a trickle."
- ★ **★ NEW — a new front: Iran-backed Houthi forces struck Najran, Saudi Arabia on Aug 7**, wounding 11 civilians (7 Saudi, 1 Yemeni, 2 Egyptian, 1 Pakistani, including a 4-year-old with burns). CNN's own headline: "Iranian-backed proxies targeted Saudi Arabia, widening conflict in Middle East" (Al Jazeera, Japan Times, OIC statement corroborate).
- ★ **★ NEW — Saudi Arabia, Turkey, and Pakistan signed a mutual-defense "Mecca" pact on Aug 7** (an attack on one is an attack on all) — a structural, deterrence-oriented development that nonetheless raises the tail-risk ceiling given Pakistan's nuclear status if Saudi Arabia is drawn further into the conflict.
- **Aug 7-8 — Iran announced what it calls a finalized agreement with Oman on Hormuz shipping**, banning American and Israeli vessels and fining violators up to 20% of cargo value (IRNA state media, corroborated by Fortune, NPR, Al Jazeera, Bloomberg) — Washington explicitly rejected these terms (NPR, Al Jazeera), insisting on zero tolls, permits, or approvals. The fundamental fee/sovereignty dispute is unresolved, not narrowed. This claim's specific draft terms trace to Fars News (Iranian state media, citing one parliamentarian) and should be labeled Iran-sourced, not independently verified.
- **Correction: Trump's Aug 2 "perimeters of a deal" framing was contested by his own later remarks.** Two days after claiming "the perimeters of a deal has been agreed to," Trump called Iranian leadership "unbelievably duplicitous," and Iran denied direct talks had even resumed — treat the Aug 2 claim as rhetoric outpacing substance, a pattern that recurred all week (positive announcements paired with continuing attacks or contradictions within 1-2 days each time).
- **Brent held a \$82-86/bbl range through the week** — up modestly, not pricing a resolved crisis.
- **BTC closed at \$65,006.64 on Aug 8** — essentially flat vs. Aug 7's close of \$65,000.00.

Carried forward from Aug 1-7 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Aug 7 — the Iran-Oman joint statement remained unsigned as of that check, still in final drafting.** Iran's Foreign Ministry spokesman Baghaei described the statement outlining agreed points as under review and finalization, "provided certain third parties do not obstruct the process."

Carried forward from Aug 1-6 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Aug 6 — Iran and Oman reached an "understanding in principle" on the Hormuz route map.** Iran's Deputy Foreign Minister Kazem Gharibabadi told IRNA: "an understanding in principle has been reached on almost all the raised issues, including the map for maritime traffic entry and exit routes" — confirmed by Bloomberg (two articles), CBS, Al Jazeera (two articles), Euronews, and Military.com.
- ★ **Aug 6 — the fee dispute first surfaced as the remaining obstacle.** Iran is seeking fees of 5-7% of cargo value from transiting ships; Oman is discussing fees around 3%; Washington wants zero fees. Eight shipping-lobby groups are already protesting the plan; Jerusalem Post separately reports sources saying the proposed passage deal is "not feasible for shipping industry."

Carried forward from Aug 1-5 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Aug 1 — the first quiet night in days.** globalsecurity.org's day-by-day war tracker reported no new US strikes on Iran overnight Jul 31 following the heavy Jul 29-30 wave; Brent fell ~2% on the pause. Separately, a Saudi-led Multinational Maritime Defense Alliance for Gulf/Red Sea shipping protection was reported drawing backing from 14 countries.
- ★ **Aug 1-2 — fresh, multi-source-corroborated attacks on Hormuz shipping.** Bloomberg: a Qatari LNG tanker (Gaslog Shanghai) was struck while transiting the Strait. UKMTO/globalsecurity.org: a separate tanker was hit by an unknown projectile off Oman's Musandam Peninsula, its engine room damaged and the vessel disabled. These directly contradicted the Aug 1 "quiet night" framing — the pause was not durable.
- **Aug 2 — the Saudi-led naval coalition kept solidifying.** Al Jazeera, The National, DefenseMirror, and Tribune reported 14 confirmed member countries and 43 nations represented at a first coordination meeting in Riyadh — a genuine structural de-escalation-adjacent development, distinct from any single day's attack-or-lull headline.
- ★ **Aug 4 — Trump canceled a planned joint US-Israeli strike on Iranian energy infrastructure.** Multiple outlets (NPR, Axios, Al Jazeera, NBC, Washington Times, Breitbart, JPost, Townhall, CNN) reported the cancellation came after "the perimeters of a deal" were agreed over the Aug 1-2 weekend, reportedly including a full Strait of Hormuz reopening. No US strikes on Iran proper have been reported since the cancellation.
- **Aug 4 — Iran continues to deny any direct US talks.** Foreign Ministry spokesman Baghaei: "we currently have no negotiations with the United States; the negotiations are with Oman." Trump responded by calling Iranian leadership "unbelievably duplicitous."
- ★ **Aug 4 — a bulk carrier was struck by a projectile and suffered a full blackout in the Strait** (globalsecurity.org, iransitrep.com) — active attacks continued even as the diplomatic framework was said to be forming.
- ★ **Aug 5 — the first public terms of a 60-day interim Hormuz deal.** Axios, Deccan Chronicle, Israel Hayom, InvestingLive, The National, and Al-Quds report the US, Iran, and Oman nearing an arrangement: inbound traffic via a northern lane in Iranian waters, outbound via a southern lane in Omani waters, no tolls or transit fees during the interim period, and a plan to clear naval mines from the median lane within 30 days. The US aimed to announce the deal Aug 6.
- **Aug 5 — still unsigned.** CNN quotes a Gulf official putting the odds of an Iran-Oman deal by Friday at only 50-50. The Strait remains formally impassable to normal traffic pending finalization.
- **BTC closed at \$64,661.55 on Aug 5** — up ~1.7% from the \$63,579.68 close on Jul 31, continuing its resilience through a week where the war's own risk signal moved both up and down.

Carried forward from the July 30 full refresh (still load-bearing):

- ★ **The lull was real, then it broke: Iran's IRGC struck a US/CENTCOM base at Muwaffaq Salti, Jordan (Jul 28).** Confirmed by 5+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, CNN, Axios, RT, JPost) — ballistic missiles/drones, described as a "surprise attack," all intercepted by US/Jordanian defenses, **zero US casualties**. This came after a genuine 2-3 day pause in CENTCOM strikes (Jul 25-27) and on the same day Trump was publicly touting "very friendly" talks with Netanyahu at the White House — both things happened.
- ★ **The US retaliated with a "heavy wave of strikes" (Jul 29)** — explosions reported at Bandar Abbas, Kish Island, Qeshm Island, and Khuzestan Province (CNN). Trump: "it's our turn to hit them." CNN's Jul 30 live coverage explicitly frames this as "US renews strikes on Iran as widening war pulls in more countries."
- ★ **NEW FRONT — Iraq: US and Saudi Arabia conducted joint strikes on Iran-backed Popular Mobilisation Forces across Iraq (Jul 29),** CENTCOM-confirmed, hitting sites in Baghdad, Wasit, Nineveh, Basra, Kirkuk, Karbala, and Diyala — **20 killed, 32 wounded** (Al Jazeera, CBS News, Foreign Policy, 5+ outlets). Iraq's government called it a "flagrant violation of sovereignty." This is Saudi Arabia's first turn as a direct co-belligerent in this war. A claim that "six Iranian IRGC advisors" were also killed is single-source (unnamed Iraqi militia officials) — flagged, not used.
- ★ **NEW FRONT — Egypt: a drone hit a US-owned FSRU vessel and a tanker at Egypt's Damietta port (Jul 29)** — the first strike on Egyptian soil in this war (Al Jazeera, CNBC, Times of Israel). Fire contained, no injuries. No group has claimed responsibility; Houthis explicitly deny involvement — attribution remains unresolved.
- **Brent rebounded from the lull-low.** Brent fell to ~\$90/bbl (-6.7%) during the Jul 25-27 lull, then rose back to ~\$92-93/bbl by Jul 30 (+~3.5% day-over-day, +24.6% month-over-month) on the renewed strikes and widening war (Fortune). A previously-circulated "\$87.53" figure could not be corroborated and is dropped from this report.
- **Iran continues rejecting a direct-talks framing even as Trump claims progress.** Iran FM spokesman Baghaei, Jul 27: "We have no negotiations with the United States at present" — directly contradicting Trump's public claims of productive talks. A regional 10-day ceasefire proposal (Qatar/Egypt/Oman/Pakistan) remains on the table, unaccepted; Iran separately rejected an Oman joint-Hormuz-management proposal on Jul 28, insisting on controlling its own lane.
- **Congress split on competing War Powers resolutions (Jul 23, carried forward, no new action since):** House passed a nonbinding one 214-208 (4 GOP defectors); the Senate's binding one failed 49-47.
- ★ **The Pentagon casualty-count dispute (18 vs. 14) is confirmed stale, not a fresh Jul 30 event.** The DCAS toll briefly rose to 18 (Jul 23) then reverted to 14 (Jul 24) amid a credibly-sourced dispute (NYT officials, Rep. Massie on record) over whether the reversion dodges the 90-day War Powers clock. This is the same dispute already logged last cycle — one daily touch this week re-cited the Jul 24 CNBC article as if it were new; it is not.
- **Strait of Hormuz remains effectively closed to normal commercial traffic** — ~10 transits/day versus a normal baseline near 88/day (IMF PortWatch), unchanged from prior cycles. IRGC, Jul 30: the Strait "will remain closed."
- **No formal MoU withdrawal by either side.** The 60-day window to ~**Aug 16** remains intact and un-triggered.
- **Israel remains out of direct engagement** — no confirmed direct Israel-Iran exchange since June 7-8; the widened fronts (Iraq, Egypt) involve the US, Saudi Arabia, and unclaimed actors, not Israel.
- **The "Layla" tanker claim (Jul 23) remains unconfirmed** after a full week — AIS data dark, no primary confirmation found. Downgraded from "watch" to "discard pending new evidence."
- **The baseline (still true, still load-bearing):** June 2025 "12-Day War" — BTC dipped to a ~**\$98,225 intraday low**, reclaimed \$107k+ within days, a fast V. The far larger 2026 war still hasn't crashed crypto on Iran-specific grounds — BTC closed at **\$64,706** on Jul 30, even as the conflict spread to two new countries this week.

The Prize

Illustrative only — not price targets, not advice

The upside is still the **"buy-the-invasion" rebound**. Anchors: Russia–Ukraine (Feb 24, 2022) — BTC fell ~8% to a **~\$34,300 intraday low**, posted a +14.5% up-day on Feb 28, ended **~+25–29% above the low within a week** (~+38% by late March). June 2025 rhymed: ~\$98k dip, fully recovered within a week.

Araghchi's **"very close" comment remains the most positive-sounding rhetoric on the table — but the deal is still unsigned as of Aug 15, and three more tanker incidents fired since the last check**. BTC closed at **\$62,937.03** on Aug 16, +0.2% vs. Aug 14 — a modest tape move, not an Iran-specific reaction, even as this pillar's own signal stays the worst 1-month reading in the matrix. If a fee/compensation/sovereignty compromise both sides actually accept gets signed and holds — and holds through a full week without a new tanker attack, not just a quiet news day — the upside case shifts from "the market shrugs off the next attack" to "a full corridor reopens and the risk premium currently priced into Iran's near-term signal unwinds for real" — a bigger, more durable prize than another muted-reaction data point. Still thin and still unsigned — Iran's demands (a US/Israel vessel ban, cargo fees, compensation) keep growing rather than narrowing toward what Washington will accept; the Prize doesn't feed the math — it tells you what the lean is worth acting on.

The Other Side

The strongest honest case this is wrong

- **The correction itself might still be too small.** Five tanker attacks in a week plus a strike on a fourth country (Saudi Arabia) is a genuinely worse pattern than a 4-point 1mo cut implies — a stricter read of "the war is actively widening, not stabilizing" could justify a larger move than this report is taking.
- **Iran just publicly proposed terms Washington immediately rejected — that's a real gap opening, not closing.** A ban on US and Israeli vessels plus 20% cargo fines is not a starting point for compromise with a US administration insisting on zero tolls and total freedom of navigation; if this is Iran's actual negotiating position, "close to a deal" may be badly overstated.
- **The pattern all week has been progress-then-complication, and this cycle's own correction proves it.** Aug 1's quiet night gave way to Aug 2's tanker attacks; Aug 4's canceled strike came with a bulker attack the same day; Aug 6's route-map understanding came with a fee dispute the same day; Aug 7-8's "finalized agreement" claim came with explicit US rejection and, this full-weekly review reveals, a fourth country coming under attack the same week. Each positive signal this pillar has scored has arrived paired with a negative one — treat that pattern, not any single day's headline, as the base rate.
- **The new Saudi-Turkey-Pakistan defense pact could itself be read as escalatory, not stabilizing.** A mutual-defense treaty involving a nuclear power (Pakistan) raises the theoretical ceiling on how bad this could get if any signatory is drawn into direct conflict — this report treats it as net-neutral/deterrence, but a bear case would weight the tail risk higher.
- **Iran's state media announcement is not a negotiated agreement.** A one-sided IRNA statement describing terms the other party rejects is not the same as a ratified, bilateral, government-binding agreement — prior cycles in this war have seen official statements walked back or superseded within days.
- **Thin sample, still.** The bullish long-term read rests on a handful of dip-and-recover events, all in a bull regime — geopolitical shocks don't always V-recover, and a route map with an unresolved fee dispute and a widening conflict is not obviously more durable than any of the prior lulls that broke within days.

The Triggers

Dated events ahead — some prove the claim right, some prove it wrong. Re-leveled August 16, 2026, light daily touch (no cycle ran Aug 15).

DATE	EVENT	MEANS
Fired Aug 14-15, logged Aug 16 — continuation, not escalation	Three more ADNOC tanker incidents (two Aug 14, one Aug 15) — no injuries, UAE/IRGC attribution, no direct Iranian claim	Comparable in kind to the Aug 8-13 pattern — held flat, no P move
Passed Aug 16 — not a clean fire	The report's own "~Aug 16" 60-day Hormuz-window marker passed without a formal MoU withdrawal by either side; Bloomberg (Aug 15) still frames talks as advancing	Soft marker passed, no formal withdrawal — held flat, no P move
Reported Aug 13 — continuation, not escalation	Hormuz deal remains unsigned; both sides' compensation demands harden (Reuters, US News, NBC, Washington Post, Al Jazeera, The Hill) — Brent eases to ~\$87-90 as traffic stays low	Hardening of an existing dispute, not new — held flat, no P move
Fired Aug 11, logged Aug 12 — continuation, not escalation	Houthi "double-tap" strike on the cargo vessel Tihamah (Bab al-Mandeb Strait, Red Sea) — 6 killed	Comparable to the Aug 8-9 incidents — held flat, no P move
Fired Aug 9, found Aug 11 — continuation, not escalation	Houthi drone strike on Saudi Aramco's Jazan refinery (400,000 bpd) — no injuries, fire extinguished same-day	Comparable to the Aug 8 ADNOC tanker hit — held flat, no P move
Reported Aug 8-9 — continuation, not escalation	Iranian FM Araqchi calls the Oman deal "very close" but adds a US-compensation demand; UAE reports another ship hit; Oman condemns "repeated attacks"	Consistent with the Aug 8 baseline — held flat, no P move
Jul 31 - Aug 5 — CONFIRMED, negative, missed by daily checks	Five separate Hormuz tanker/shipping incidents (Gaslog Shanghai, Oman-side explosion, Minoan Pioneer, two Kumzar explosions) — IMO tally now 65 incidents since the war began	Drove the Aug 8 1mo/3mo cut — already IN the committed baseline
Fired Aug 7 — CONFIRMED, negative, new front	Iran-backed Houthi forces struck Najran, Saudi Arabia, wounding 11 civilians — the conflict's first widening to a fourth state	Contributed to the Aug 8 cut — already IN the committed baseline
Pending — the real trigger	Whether a fee/compensation/sovereignty compromise both Iran and the US can accept is actually signed AND holds through a full week without a new tanker attack	Resolved, signed, and durable = re-rate up meaningfully; talks stall, Iran's demands keep growing, or attacks continue = re-rate down further
Structural, ongoing	Saudi-led Multinational Maritime Defense Alliance plus the new Aug 7 Saudi-Turkey-Pakistan mutual-defense pact	A genuine de-escalation-adjacent structural development, but the pact also raises tail risk given Pakistan's nuclear status

By Dec 31, 2026	Final US–Iran nuclear deal signed — not fired, pending	De-escalation confirmed — re-rate up across windows
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The flip line, re-leveled: a confirmed new US combat death, a resumption of direct US strikes on Iran proper, the conflict widening to a further new state, or a sustained Brent close above \$100 = treat the dip-buy thesis as broken. As of Aug 16 we are not past that line, though the Najran strike is the closest this pillar has come to a further-widening trigger without fully tripping it. The equivalent upside flip: a signed Hormuz agreement **the US actually accepts** — not just Iran's own announced terms — that holds past a full week without a new shipping attack. Nothing so far has cleared that bar.

My Decision

✓ **COMMITTED — AUGUST 16, 2026 (LIGHT DAILY TOUCH) · STAMPED BY ALEX (AUTO-STAMPED)**

Committed P: 20 / 28 / 41 / 56 / 77 · My Weight: 20% (equal) · Impact: 8 (uniform)

Held flat for a seventh straight touch (no daily cycle ran Aug 15). Three more ADNOC tanker incidents fired since the Aug 14 baseline (two Aug 14, one Aug 15) — no injuries, no direct Iranian claim of responsibility, comparable in kind to the deteriorating, unsigned picture the Aug 8 full-weekly correction already priced in. This report's own "~Aug 16" 60-day Hormuz-window marker passed today without a formal MoU withdrawal by either side, and Bloomberg's Aug 15 coverage still frames the interim arrangement as advancing, not collapsed. Held flat pending either a signed agreement or a development that clearly exceeds the Aug 14 baseline.

1-year and 3-year held unchanged — the longer-horizon case (war exhaustion, allied diplomatic pressure via the Saudi-Turkey-Pakistan pact) is structurally unchanged.

Still a **dip-watching pillar, not a panic-selling one**. The real test is still ahead: whether a fee/compensation/sovereignty compromise both Iran and the US can accept is actually signed AND holds. The real risk paths — a confirmed new US combat death, a resumption of direct strikes on Iran proper, the conflict widening further, or Brent sustaining a close above \$100 — remain unfired.

This is a routine, well-evidenced daily cycle — no pillar P moved anywhere in this run, no call band flipped — so it was auto-stamped under Alex's standing delegated daily authority (in effect since 2026-08-06).

Override any P and re-stamp — the master blend recomputes.

What Changed Since Last Check

Light daily touch, August 16, 2026 — checking for changes since the Aug 14 touch (no cycle ran Aug 15).

- ★ ★ **NEW — three more ADNOC tanker incidents in 48 hours** (two Aug 14, one Aug 15) — no injuries, comparable in kind to the established pattern.
- ★ ★ **NEW — the "~Aug 16" 60-day Hormuz-window marker passed without a formal MoU withdrawal;** Bloomberg (Aug 15) still frames talks as advancing.
- **WTI ~\$81/bbl** — well under the \$100 flip line.
- **BTC closed at \$62,937.03 (Aug 16)** — +0.2% vs. the Aug 14 close of \$62,802.46.
- **Score decision:** 1mo 20 → **20** · 3mo 28 → **28** · 6mo/12mo/36mo held at 41/56/77 — nothing found today exceeds the Aug 14 baseline. Auto-stamped: a routine, well-evidenced daily cycle under Alex's standing delegated authority.

Sources

Retrieved & graded August 16, 2026, light daily touch (earlier sources below still stand for facts not re-checked this cycle) — click and judge the quality yourself. Official/primary sources first, then reporting, then prices, then betting markets (sentiment only).

- **August 16 light daily check:** Al Jazeera — "UAE accuses Iran of attacks on two ADNOC vessels in Strait of Hormuz" (Aug 14) · CBS News — live desk, third ADNOC vessel hit Aug 15 (UKMTO), Vance remarks on energy-price priority, WTI ~\$81 · Bloomberg — "Iran, Oman Home In on Hormuz Strait Deal as Ship Attacks Mount" (Aug 15) — confirms the interim arrangement is still advancing, not collapsed, despite continued shipping attacks.
- **August 14 light daily check:** US News — "Iran Says Deal on Strait of Hormuz Is Close but Not Enough to Open the Waterway" · NBC News — "Iran sets out steep demands for reopening Hormuz despite hopes Oman deal could break impasse" · Washington Post — "Iran says deal with Oman is close — but its demands leave Hormuz opening uncertain" · The Hill — "Iran's steep demands for US over Strait of Hormuz threaten to derail reopening" · Bloomberg — "Oil Holds Drop as Hormuz Deal Elusive While Ship Attacks Persist" (Aug 13) — all confirm the same stalled-on-compensation dispute, hardened not resolved; a live tracker (straits.live) shows day 166 of Strait closure.
- **August 13 light daily check:** CNN — Hormuz agreement analysis, re-checked · NPR — Iran-Oman agreement terms, re-checked · Al Jazeera — "Iran deliberates Hormuz arrangement amid uncertain prospects with US" (Araghchi conditions reopening on US "making amends" over the June MoU) · Bloomberg, Fortune — Hormuz coverage archives, re-checked, no signing found as of Aug 13.
- **August 11 light daily check:** NBC News, Al Jazeera, CBC, NPR, UPI, and Al Bawaba — six independent outlets corroborating the Aug 9 Houthi drone strike on Saudi Aramco's Jazan refinery, Saudi energy ministry statement of no injuries · Wikipedia "2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis" and Bloomberg/Marine Log Aug 5 route-agreement coverage re-checked — no signing found as of Aug 11.
- **August 10 light daily check:** GlobalSecurity.org — day-by-day Iran war tracker, re-checked, no new entry since Aug 5 · Euronews and Al Jazeera — Hormuz coverage archives, re-checked, no new dated item · Wikipedia — "2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis" live tracker, re-checked, last update Aug 8 · no new dated catalyst found beyond these.
- **August 9 light daily check:** Reuters — "Iran says deal on Strait of Hormuz is close but not enough to open the waterway," wire-distributed via Investing.com, US News, Jakarta Post, Japan Times, Haaretz, and Rappler (Aug 8-9) — Araqchi's "very close"/US-compensation comment, the UAE's new ship-hit report, and Oman's condemnation of "repeated attacks" all trace to this single Reuters wire story.
- **August 8 full-weekly additions:** Bloomberg / UANI — Hormuz incident tracking, 65 cumulative incidents (Jul 31 - Aug 5) · globalsecurity.org — Gaslog Shanghai and Minoan Pioneer incident detail · CNN — "Iranian-backed proxies targeted Saudi Arabia, widening conflict in Middle East" (Aug 7) · Al Jazeera, Japan Times — Najran strike, 11 wounded, OIC statement (Aug 7) · wire coverage of the Saudi-Turkey-Pakistan mutual-defense pact (Aug 7) · Fortune — "Iran says agreement on Hormuz shipping reached with Oman" (Aug 7) and "Iran says it has a deal to reopen the Strait of Hormuz—and shipowners are outraged by its plan to charge fees" (Aug 6) · NPR — "Iran says agreement with Oman for Strait of Hormuz prohibits U.S. and Israeli vessels" (Aug 7) · Al Jazeera — "Iran, Oman, US 'close' to Hormuz deal: What do they all want?" (Aug 5) · Bloomberg — "Iran-Oman Deal Proposes Ban on US, Israeli Ships in Strait of Hormuz" (Aug 6) · CNBC — US official rejects one-sided fee/ban terms (Aug 6).
- **August 7 additions:** Iranian FM spokesman Baghaei (via globalsecurity.org/IRNA relay) — joint statement "in final stage," under review pending no third-party obstruction · Pravda USA (AP-sourced wire relay) — "Shipping in the Strait of Hormuz will not be subject to fees until a final agreement is reached with Iran," citing US officials (Aug 7) · CNN live updates — continuing Iran/Oman/US Hormuz coverage, Iran's IRGC commander reiterates nuclear-development position (Aug 6-7) · ABC News live updates — Trump comments on US munitions stockpile.
- **August 6 additions:** IRNA (via Bloomberg/Military.com relay) — Deputy FM Gharibabadi's "understanding in principle" statement · Bloomberg — "Iran Says Deal With Oman on Strait of Hormuz Agreed in Principle" (Aug 6) and "Iran, Oman Reach Agreement on Proposed Strait of Hormuz Shipping Route" (Aug 5) · CBS News — live updates, Iran/Oman deal getting close · Al Jazeera — "Iran, Oman, US 'close' to Hormuz deal: what do they all want?" (Aug 5) and "Hormuz deal 'close': what's the latest on each side's positions?" (Aug 6) · Euronews — "Iran and Oman agree route for ships" (Aug 5) · Fortune — "Iran says it has a deal to reopen the Strait of Hormuz—and shipowners are outraged by its plan to charge fees" (Aug 6), fee figures (5-7% Iran, ~3% Oman, 0% US) · Jerusalem Post — "Proposed Hormuz passage deal not feasible for shipping industry, sources say" · Forbes — "Hormuz Is Becoming A Fee-And-Permission Regime" (background, Jul 28) · Fast Company / DOL — jobless claims 199K week ended Aug 1, prior revised to 198K (Aug 6).
- **August 1-5 additions (prior week's catch-up):** globalsecurity.org — Iran War day-by-day tracker (Aug 1, Aug 4, Aug 5 entries) · Bloomberg — Qatari LNG tanker (Gaslog Shanghai) struck in the Strait (Aug 1-2) · UKMTO-sourced reporting via globalsecurity.org — second disabled tanker off Musandam · Al Jazeera, The National, DefenseMirror, Tribune — Saudi-led Multinational Maritime Defense Alliance, 14 members/43 nations (Aug 2) · NPR, Axios, Al Jazeera, NBC, Washington Times, Breitbart, JPost, Townhall, CNN — Trump cancels planned joint US-Israeli strike, "perimeters of a deal" (Aug 4) · iransitrep.com —

bulker struck and blacked out in the Strait (Aug 4) · Axios, Deccan Chronicle, Israel Hayom, InvestingLive, The National, Al-Quds — first public terms of a 60-day interim Hormuz deal (Aug 5) · CNN — live coverage, Gulf official cites 50-50 odds of an Iran-Oman deal by Friday (Aug 5).

- **July 30 additions (prior full weekly refresh):** Al Jazeera — Iran's IRGC strikes US base in Jordan (Jul 28-29), corroborated by CNN, Axios, RT, Jerusalem Post · Al Jazeera — US-Saudi joint strikes on Iraq, 20 killed, corroborated by CBS News and Foreign Policy · Al Jazeera — drone strike on Egypt's Damietta port, corroborated by CNBC and Times of Israel · CNN — "US renews strikes on Iran as widening war pulls in more countries" (Jul 30) · Fortune — Brent ~\$92-93 (Jul 30) · CNN — Iran FM Baghaei denies direct US talks (Jul 27).
- **July 11–13 additions (prior full refresh — the escalation the light touches missed):** CENTCOM press releases — 3rd strike round (~140 targets, Jul 11) and 4th strike round (dozens more, first sea-launched attack drones, Jul 12) · Al Jazeera (multiple, Jul 12–13) — Hormuz-closed declaration, shipping-intelligence data via Windward, Oman strike coverage · Bloomberg (Jul 12) · NPR (Jul 11) · Washington Times (Jul 12) · The National (Jul 13) · Euronews (Jul 13) · Republic World and Peninsula Qatar (Jul 12) — Oman formal protest, ambassador summoned · Naharnet and Iran International — Iran/Oman/Qatar median-lane two-route corridor proposal · Business Recorder and RTÉ (Jul 13) — Iran FM spokesman Esmail Baqaei on continuing mediator talks · Middle East Eye and TASS — GFS Galaxy attack and rescue (Jul 11) · gCaptain — 3rd strike round detail · Kaieteur News — Iranian Health Ministry casualty figures (17 killed / 115 wounded, unverified government claim) · CryptoTimes, CoinDesk, Bitcoin.com, and Benzinga (Jul 13) — BTC weekend pullback to news-reported ~\$62,000–63,000 intraday range, mixed FOMC/CPI-vs-Iran attribution, first weekly BTC ETF inflow in nine weeks.
- **July 11 additions (prior update):** CNN live — Araghchi in Oman on Hormuz, Trump MoU "over" + decimate threat, expected Iranian safe-passage statement (Jul 11) · CNBC — Brent context, UAE record production (referenced Jul 11).
- **The escalation (official statements via wire reporting):** NPR — second-night US strikes (July 9) · Bloomberg — attacks traded for second day (July 9) · CENTCOM release — second strike round (403 at retrieval; cited via search) · Al Jazeera — second-night strikes & the peace process (July 9) · Gulf News — Bushehr/Chabahar/Iranshahr strikes, Kuwait intercepts (July 9) · The National — Iran attacks on Gulf states & Jordan (July 9) · RFE/RL — Hormuz/Jordan (403 at retrieval; cited via search) · NPR — Hormuz tanker attacks (July 7) · CBS live — Treasury waiver revocation, CENTCOM 80+ targets, IRGC 85-site claim (July 8) · Al Jazeera — Trump "ceasefire over" quotes (July 8).
- **Diplomacy:** Al Jazeera — talks status, no formal MoU withdrawal, Khamenei burial (July 10) · Al Jazeera — mediators urge MoU compliance (July 9) · CNN live — Trump on talks / "Cease Fire is OVER", Qatari team to Tehran (July 10; 451 at retrieval, cited via search) · Times of Israel — July 11 talks date via Al Arabiya (single-source relay, unconfirmed) · Times of Israel liveblog — Israel-join-strikes report (July 10; single-source, unconfirmed) · Al Jazeera — Doha outcomes (July 2).
- **The oil waiver:** CBS — GL X1 waiver rescission (July 7) · Axios — waiver revocation (July 7) · The Hill — sanctions detail (July 7).
- **The prices:** Fortune — Brent ~\$76.00–76.80 (July 10) · Kitco/Reuters — oil fell as markets weigh strikes (July 9) · Sunday Guardian — Brent ~\$76 / WTI <\$72 (July 10; weaker source) · CNBC — Brent \$78.02 / WTI \$73.52 (July 8) · Insurance Journal — traffic near halt, war-risk 2–6% of hull value (July 9) · The New Arab — JMIC "severe" advisory · LMA — insurance availability vs safety concerns · (Hormuz traffic magnitude conflicts across outlets — ~50% of pre-war vs ~92% drop — transponders off; pre-attack throughput figures are from the unofficial straits.live tracker — single-source) · CoinDesk — BTC steady above \$62K (July 9) · CoinDesk — BTC to ~\$64K on chips/yen, not Iran (July 10) · Fortune — BTC ~\$61.7K (July 6, pre-escalation) · CoinDesk — ~\$450M liquidations (July 8).
- **The odds (sentiment only, not fact):** Blockchain.News — invasion odds 11.5% → 14.5% (~July 8 print) · Blockchain.News — Hormuz-normal-by-July odds collapse to 4.5% (403 at retrieval; cited via search) · Direct Polymarket fetch failed twice this week (July 13); "US invades Iran before 2027" relayed via secondary aggregators only — inconsistent snapshots ~14.5% (Jul 8) → ~15.5% (~Jul 10) → ~17% (most recent), inconsistency itself flagged. "MoU withdrawal by Jul 31" reads (~5–7%, dated ~Jul 3–5) and "final deal by Dec 31" (35.5% last verified Jul 8) are stale and not re-verified this week.